
HOMOPHONES, HOMONYMS & COMMONLY CONFUSED WORDS

1. INTRODUCTION

Vocabulary plays an important role in: reading comprehension, grammar, writing, communication skills, and TNTET examinations.

Among vocabulary topics, TNTET frequently asks questions from:

- **Homophones,**
- **Homonyms,**
- **Commonly Confused Words.**

2. WHAT ARE HOMOPHONES?

Homophones are words that:

- have the same pronunciation (sound),
- but different spellings and meanings.

TEXTBOOK DEFINITIONS**Class 7 Textbook:**

“Homophones are two words that are spelled differently but have the same sound.”

Class 8 Textbook:

“Homophones are words with the same pronunciation but different meanings, origins, or spelling.”

Class 10 Textbook:

“Homophones are words that sound the same but have different meanings and spellings.”

MEMORY TRICK

“Homo = Same | Phone = Sound”

- 👉 Same sound
- 👉 Different spelling
- 👉 Different meaning

3. WHAT ARE HOMONYMS?

Homonyms are words that:

- have the same spelling,
- same pronunciation,
- but different meanings.

TEXTBOOK DEFINITION**Class 8 Textbook:**

“Two or more words having the same spelling and pronunciation but different meanings and origins.”

MEMORY TRICK

“Homo = Same | Nym = Name/Word”

- 👉 Same word
- 👉 Different meanings

4. DIFFERENCE BETWEEN HOMOPHONES & HOMONYMS

Feature	Homophones	Homonyms
Pronunciation	Same	Same
Spelling	Different	Same
Meaning	Different	Different
Example	sea / see	bat / bat

5. HOMOPHONES FROM CLASS-06 TEXTBOOK

Homophone Pair	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
pray / prey	worship	hunted animal
hole / whole	opening	complete
night / knight	dark time	soldier
sent / scent	dispatched	smell
see / sea	look	ocean

Examples in Sentences

pray / prey

- We pray to God.
- Deer became prey to the tiger.

hole / whole

- There is a hole in the wall.
- He spent the whole day reading.

6. HOMOPHONES FROM CLASS-07 TEXTBOOK

Homophone Pair	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
see / sea	look	ocean
knight / night	warrior	darkness
right / write	correct	put into words
arms / alms	body parts/weapons	charity

fair / fare	just/exhibition	travel fee
here / hear	this place	listen
heard / herd	listened	group of animals
our / hour	belonging to us	60 minutes
no / know	negative	understand
not / knot	negative word	tied rope

Sentence Examples

right / write

- Your answer is right.
- Please write neatly.

fair / fare

- She is fair and honest.
- Bus fare has increased.

7. HOMONYMS FROM CLASS-07 TEXTBOOK

Word	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
rose	flower	got up
fair	exhibition	just
saw	looked	cutting tool
right	correct	direction
well	healthy	water source
march	walk	month
can	ability	container
live	alive	reside
tears	drops from eyes	rips
second	next position	unit of time

Example Sentences

Well

- She is not feeling well.
- Water is drawn from the well.

Can

- I can swim.
- Bring me a can of juice.

8. HOMOPHONES FROM CLASS-08 TEXTBOOK

Homophone Pair	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
aloud / allowed	loudly	permitted
blue / blew	colour	wind action
meat / meet	flesh	see someone
role / roll	character	turn over
scene / seen	place/view	viewed
due / dew	expected	water drops
capitol / capital	government building	city
bored / board	uninterested	wooden plank
scent / cent	smell	coin
son / sun	male child	star

Example Sentences

meat / meet

- I do not eat meat.
- I will meet you tomorrow.

son / sun

- His son studies in Class 8.
- The sun rises in the east.

9. HOMONYMS FROM CLASS-08 TEXTBOOK

Homonym	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
address	location	speech
band	music group	ring
bat	animal	cricket bat
right	correct	direction
bright	intelligent	shining
express	fast	convey
kind	type	caring
well	healthy	water source

Example Sentences

bat

- A bat flew in the cave.
- He bought a cricket bat.

kind

- What kind of food do you like?
- She is very kind to children.

10. HOMOPHONES & HOMONYMS FROM CLASS-09 TEXTBOOK

HOMONYMS

Word	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
cricket	sport	insect
bank	financial institution	river side
will	future auxiliary	legal document
bark	dog sound	tree covering
watch	timepiece	observe
bat	animal	sports equipment

Example Sentences

bank

- I deposited money in the bank.
- The children played on the river bank.

bark

- The dog barked loudly.
- The bark of this tree is rough.

HOMOPHONES

Word	Homophone
in	inn
know	no
be	bee
to	two/too
watt	what
right	write

were	where
bare	bear
herd	heard
throne	thrown

11. HOMOPHONES & COMMONLY CONFUSED WORDS - CLASS-10 TEXTBOOK

Pair	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
knew / new	past of know	fresh
herd / heard	animal group	listened
course / coarse	training path	rough
four / fore	number	front
peace / piece	harmony	part

Example Sentences

peace / piece

- We must work for peace.
- Give me a piece of cake.

12. COMMONLY CONFUSED WORDS

These words:

- look alike,
- sound alike,
- or have related meanings, but are used differently.

Important Pairs

Word	Meaning
brought	carried
bought	purchased
affect	influence
effect	result
pocket	small cloth bag
packet	container
fond	liking
found	discovered

lost	misplaced
last	final
paused	stopped briefly
passed	moved ahead
pitcher	water container/baseball player
picture	image

Example Sentences

affect / effect

- Heavy rain affected crops.
- The medicine had a good effect.

brought / bought

- She brought a notebook.
- He bought a new pen.

13. HETERONYMS

Heteronyms are words that:

- have the same spelling,
- but different pronunciation,
- and different meanings.

MEMORY TRICK

“Hetero = Different”

- 👉 Same spelling
- 👉 Different pronunciation
- 👉 Different meaning

SIMPLE FORMULA

Same Spelling + Different Pronunciation + Different Meaning = Heteronyms

Examples of Heteronyms

Word	Pronunciation	Meaning
lead	/leed/	to guide
lead	/led/	a metal
wind	/wind/	moving air
wind	/waind/	turn/twist
tear	/teer/	drop from eye

tear	/tair/	rip
live	/liv/	reside
live	/laiv/	alive/broadcast

Example Sentences

Lead: /leed/ - She will lead the team.
 /led/ - The pipe is made of lead.

Wind: /wind/ - The wind is strong today.
 /waind/ - Wind the clock properly.

Difference Between Homonyms & Heteronyms

Feature	Homonyms	Heteronyms
Spelling	Same	Same
Pronunciation	Same	Different
Meaning	Different	Different

EASY COMPARISON

Type	Example	Pronunciation
Homonym	bat / bat	Same
Heteronym	lead / lead	Different

COMMON HETERONYMS

Word	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
object	thing	oppose
minute	60 seconds	very small
present	gift	to introduce
content	subject matter/material	satisfied/happy
conduct	behaviour	guide/manage
desert	dry land	abandon

Example Sentences

Present - /prezənt/ - I received a present.
 /prizənt/ - She will present the report.

QUICK MEMORY TABLE

Topic	Same Spelling	Same Sound	Different Meaning
Homophones	✗	✓	✓
Homonyms	✓	✓	✓
Heteronyms	✓	✗	✓

***Note:** Heteronyms are sometimes known as heterophones.

TNTET POSSIBLE QUESTION

“Lead” and “Lead” are:

- a) Homophones b) Homonyms c) Heteronyms d) Synonyms

✓ Answer: c) Heteronyms

TNTET HIGH-SCORING TECHNIQUES

Technique 1 – Understand Meaning through Context

Example

- The dog barked loudly.
- The bark of the tree is rough.

Same word → different meaning → Homonym

Technique 2 – Check Spelling Carefully

Example

- peace ≠ piece
- course ≠ coarse

Technique 3 – Learn in Pairs

Example

- sea / see
- know / no
- hear / here

Technique 4 – Use Memory Association

Example

- sea → ocean
- see → eyes

14. TNTET FREQUENTLY ASKED AREAS

Question Type	Example
Fill in the blanks	peace/piece
Match the pair	sea-see
Error spotting	affect/effect
Meaning identification	bank

15. QUICK REVISION TABLE

Topic	Key Idea
Homophones	Same sound, different spelling
Homonyms	Same spelling & sound, different meaning
Commonly Confused Words	Similar-looking or sounding words

16. COMMON TNTET CONFUSIONS

Wrong Usage	Correct Usage
I want a peace of cake.	I want a piece of cake.
The sun is my son.	The sun rises in the east.
Please right neatly.	Please write neatly.
He bought the books from the library.	He brought the books from the library.

17. TNTET MODEL QUESTIONS

1. Choose the correct homophone: The cat caught the _____ of the mouse.

- a) scent b) cent c) sent d) seat ☒ Answer: a) scent

2. Identify the homonym:

- a) sea b) see c) bat d) peace ☒ Answer: c) bat

3. Choose the correct word: She _____ a new dress yesterday.

- a) brought b) bought c) buy d) bring ☒ Answer: b) bought

4. "Right" and "Write" are:

- a) Synonyms b) Antonyms c) Homophones d) Homonyms

☒ Answer: c) Homophones

5. Choose the correct sentence:

- a) I no the answer. b) I know the answer.
c) I now the answer. d) I knew the answer tomorrow.

☒ Answer: b) I know the answer.

18. FINAL EXAM STRATEGY FOR TNTET

Step-by-Step Method

Step 1: Read the full sentence carefully.

Step 2: Understand the meaning.

Step 3: Check spelling.

Step 4: Identify whether:

- sound is same,
- spelling is same,
- or meaning is different.

Step 5: Choose the correct word based on context.

FINAL MEMORY MAP

- Same Sound + Different Spelling → Homophones
- Same Sound + Same Spelling + Different Meaning → Homonyms
- Same Spelling + Different Pronunciation + Different Meaning = Heteronyms
- Look alike / Sound alike → Commonly Confused Words

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